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Use of WhatsApp

1 message

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To: Georgie Hodgson <georgiehodgson@cottesmore.brighton-hove.sch.uk>

Bcc: Tammy Buchanan <tammy.buchanan@dataprotection.education>

Hi Georgie,

Following our meeting this morning please find below some further guidance about why WhatsApp is not recommended for conducting school business:

- Whilst data may not be physically held by the organisation, the organisation must be able to retrieve and make available any such data in response to subject access requests under the Data Protection Act 2018, or Freedom of Information requests under the Freedom of Information Act 2000. (Please see the DPE Model Work Out of School Policy under the Resources section of the Knowledgebank).
- School business is only protected by the school's information security and data retention when held in school owned and administered systems.
- Access cannot be revoked when school data is held on individuals' phones. If employees leave then they could still have access to the information, including potentially sensitive data.
- WhatsApp does not provide any controls over access control, so everyone in the group has access to all the information. Staff should only have access to information that is necessary and kept to a minimum to mitigate risk.
- Anyone with access to the device also has access to the information, i.e. family members.

I hope that helps.

Many thanks,

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